Digital Literacy Project Report

Course Code: CSE0001

Name: Raghav Bansal

Registration No.: 25BCE11321

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Introduction

As a newly selected Student Digital Ambassador, my goal with this project was to bridge the gap between basic internet usage and professional digital fluency. This portfolio serves as a centralized hub on GitHub, showcasing my ability to communicate safely, collaborate effectively, and maintain a professional online presence. Over five modules, I explored tools ranging from Canva for design to GitHub for version control, reflecting the multifaceted nature of digital literacy in a modern academic and professional environment.

Task 1 Write-up: Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For my first assignment as an Ambassador, I designed a visual guide using **[Canva]**. My infographic focuses on three core pillars: defining digital literacy, identifying essential student

tools like Google Workspace, and outlining safe internet practices such as two-factor authentication.

I chose a minimalist layout with high-contrast colors to make the information "scannable" for busy students. What I found most interesting was the challenge of "information hierarchy"—deciding which tips were most vital and which had to be cut to keep the page clean. Initially, I struggled with the layout of the "Email Etiquette" section, but after experimenting with different icons, I managed to create a flow that guides the reader's eye naturally from top to bottom.

Task 2 Write-up: Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

To establish my professional foundation, I focused on **GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle**

- **LinkedIn:** I updated my education section to reflect my current B. Tech journey at VIT Bhopal, which I plan to use for networking and finding summer internships.
- **GitHub:** I set up my profile README to introduce myself to the developer community, listing my branch and my interest in [Mention a specific interest, e.g., Web Development].
- **[Kaggle]:** This will be my space for getting jobs and stuff

Over the next four years, I plan to use these platforms as a "living resume," documenting my projects in real-time rather than waiting until graduation to build a presence.

Task 3 Write-up: Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

In this module, I expanded my technical and collaborative toolkit. For the coding practice, I used **Hacker Rank** and completed the **Python challenge** It was a refreshing way to test my logic outside of a classroom environment.

For the collaboration component, I built a 5-question Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz using **Google Forms**. Creating the logic for multiple-choice questions and then viewing the automated responses in **Google Sheets** showed me how easily I can collect and analyze data for future group projects. These tools are essential for my academic career, especially for coordinating lab reports and peer reviews in a cloud-based environment.

Task 4 Write-up: Draft a Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

Effective communication is the "soft" side of digital literacy. I drafted two distinct emails: one requesting a deadline extension from a professor and another expressing interest in a summer internship. Writing these made me realize how a simple subject line can determine whether an email is opened or ignored.

The most impactful part of this task was researching poor digital communication. I read about a situation where a student’s "joke" in a public forum was misinterpreted by a recruiter, leading to a lost job offer. This highlighted that our

digital footprint is permanent. It taught me that professional tone isn't just about being "polite"—it's about being clear, concise, and mindful of the permanent nature of digital text.

Task 5 Write-up: Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention

For the final task, I researched cyberbullying What surprised me most was the psychological aspect of these crimes; hackers don't just "break into" systems—they often trick people into letting them in through social engineering.

I was particularly alarmed by how sophisticated phishing emails have become, often mimicking official college or bank notifications. As a result, one habit I am changing immediately is how I handle links; I will no longer click on "urgent" notification links in SMS or email without first verifying the sender's address manually. Staying safe is a continuous process of staying sceptical.

Conclusion

This project has shifted my perspective of "Digital Literacy" from just "knowing how to use a computer" to "knowing how to exist responsibly in a digital society". From securing my accounts to building a professional brand, I feel much more prepared to navigate the next four years of my engineering degree

References:

Canva: https://canva.com

GitHub: https://github.com

National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal

Kaggle

Hacker Rank

Hacker Earth

Code Chef